

PMP EXAM AT A GLANCE

Items	180 total — 170 scored, 10 unscored pretest
Time	240 minutes (4 hours)
Breaks	Two 10-minute breaks; you cannot go back to a finished section
Formats	Multiple-choice single or multiple response, drag-and-drop, and practicum hands-on testing that may include tools, data and case-study questions
Blueprint	July 2026 Exam Content Outline
Approach mix	About 40% predictive; the other 60% split between agile and hybrid

DOMAIN WEIGHTS (JULY 2026 ECO)

Domain	Share of items
I. People	33%
II. Process	41%
III. Business Environment	26%

TIP Business Environment jumped from 8% to 26%. Expect questions on value, benefits, compliance, sustainability and AI-assisted delivery, not just team and schedule mechanics.

EARNED VALUE — MEMORISE COLD

Cost variance	$CV = EV - AC$ Negative = over budget
Schedule variance	$SV = EV - PV$ Negative = behind plan
Cost index	$CPI = EV \div AC$ Under 1.0 = over budget
Schedule index	$SPI = EV \div PV$ Under 1.0 = behind plan
EAC, typical	$EAC = BAC \div CPI$ Current cost performance continues
EAC, atypical	$EAC = AC + (BAC - EV)$ The overrun was a one-off
EAC, both drift	$EAC = AC + (BAC - EV) \div (CPI \times SPI)$ Cost and schedule both off
Estimate to complete	$ETC = EAC - AC$
Variance at completion	$VAC = BAC - EAC$
To-complete index	$TCPI = (BAC - EV) \div (BAC - AC)$ That is the index to meet BAC; to meet an approved EAC, $TCPI = (BAC - EV) \div (EAC - AC)$

ESTIMATING, SCHEDULE, RISK

Three-point (beta)	$(O + 4M + P) \div 6$ Triangular is $(O + M + P) \div 3$
Activity std. deviation	$(P - O) \div 6$
Total float	$LS - ES$ (or $LF - EF$) Critical-path activities normally have zero total float; imposed constraints can create positive or negative total float
Communication channels	$n(n - 1) \div 2$ n = people, not links
Expected monetary value	$EMV = \text{probability} \times \text{impact}$ Threats negative, opportunities positive
Return on investment	$ROI = (\text{benefit} - \text{cost}) \div \text{cost}$

PEOPLE DOMAIN RECALL

- Team development: forming, storming, norming, performing, adjourning.
- Ground rules and a team charter set expectations and can reduce avoidable conflict.
- Address the issue directly and coach within your authority; involve management or escalate when policy, risk or authority requires it.
- Emotional intelligence: self-awareness, self-management, social awareness, relationship management.
- Virtual teams need explicit communication norms and shared information radiators.

BUSINESS ENVIRONMENT RECALL

- Business case and benefits realisation plan justify and measure the project.
- Compliance is non-negotiable: identify requirements, plan for them, audit them.
- Value = benefits delivered against cost, risk and time — not output volume.
- Organisational change: assess readiness, communicate, train, reinforce adoption.
- Check enterprise environmental factors and organisational process assets before inventing a process.



PICK THE RIGHT ANSWER FIRST

- Address issues directly when appropriate; escalate when risk, policy or authority requires it.
- Predictive baselines change through integrated change control; adaptive and hybrid work changes through the agreed backlog, product and governance process.
- Gather facts and analyse impact before you act on a symptom.
- Favor servant and collaborative leadership when appropriate: remove impediments, support and coach the team, while adapting leadership style to the situation.
- Deliver value early and get feedback rather than perfecting a plan.
- Follow the organisation's governance, compliance and ethics rules — always.

RISK RESPONSES

Threat	Opportunity
Avoid — remove the cause	Exploit — make it certain
Transfer — shift to a third party	Share — partner to capture it
Mitigate — cut probability or impact	Enhance — raise probability or impact
Accept — active or passive	Accept — take it if it arrives
Escalate — outside your authority	Escalate — outside your authority

CONTRACTS: WHO CARRIES THE RISK

Type	Buyer risk	Use when
Firm fixed price	Low	Scope is well defined
Fixed price incentive	Low–med	You want a cost or delivery incentive
Cost plus fixed fee	High	Scope is uncertain
Cost plus incentive/award	High	You reward performance
Time and materials	Medium	Staff augmentation, short work

AGILE AND HYBRID RECALL

- Sprint up to 1 month; daily scrum 15 min; review then retrospective at the end.
- The product owner is accountable for ordering the product backlog; developers are responsible for sizing and own the sprint backlog and its plan.
- Definition of done is the quality gate; acceptance criteria are per story.
- Velocity is for forecasting one team — never for comparing teams or judging people.
- Burndown shows work left; cumulative flow shows queues and work in progress.
- High uncertainty and fast feedback favour adaptive; stable scope and heavy compliance favour predictive.

COMMON TRAPS

- "Escalate to the sponsor" is rarely first — act inside your authority first.
- Collaborate/problem-solve often gives the most durable resolution; fit the approach to urgency, stakes, authority and context.
- A risk that occurs becomes an issue: manage it in the issue log and update or close the related risk-register entry.
- Sunk cost never justifies continuing — decide on remaining value.
- Lessons learned are recorded throughout, not only at closing.

TEST-DAY PLAN

1. Roughly 80 seconds per item — flag and move, do not stall.
2. Read the last sentence first, then mine the scenario for what it actually asks.
3. Strike clearly wrong options, then choose the remaining answer that best fits the stated context, authority, governance and delivery approach.
4. Case-study sets: answer them as one story; you cannot return after the break.
5. Answer every item — there is no penalty for a guess.

TIP Confirm item counts, timing and break rules in the current PMI Certification Handbook and PMP Exam Content Outline before your appointment.

